

NODO DANCE

MASTER STARTUP KNOWLEDGE BASE

Vision, mission, product strategy, business model, engineering principles and Obsidian agent instructions.

Version 3.0 | November 2026 | Charlotte-first | AI agent reference

Discover. Connect. Book. Manage. Grow.

A unified platform where dancers discover experiences, instructors build their businesses, organizers sell tickets, and dance communities grow.

1. Executive summary

Nodo Dance is an integrated discovery, ticketing, instructor marketplace, and business management platform for the partner dance industry. It connects dancers, instructors, schools, studios, event organizers, DJs, and venues in one ecosystem.

Today, dance discovery, registration, payments, lesson scheduling, attendance and student relationships are scattered across Instagram, WhatsApp, Facebook, standalone ticketing platforms, spreadsheets and individual websites. Nodo aims to join these fragmented experiences in one dance-specific platform.

Elevator pitch

> **Nodo Dance is building the all-in-one marketplace and operating system for the dance industry, combining event discovery, ticketing, instructor bookings, and studio management into a single platform.**

Mission

> **To connect and empower dance communities by making it effortless to discover events, learn from instructors, organize experiences, and grow a sustainable dance business.**

Vision

> **To become the global digital infrastructure for dance - the platform where every dancer can find their community and every dance professional can build their business.**

Five user questions

- Where can I dance?
- Who can teach me?
- How can I book and pay?
- How can I manage my students, classes and events?
- How can I grow my dance business?

2. Product inspirations and differentiation

Reference	Capabilities Nodo can adapt
Eventbrite	Event discovery, ticket sales, registration, organizer tools
Meetup	Local community discovery, groups, recurring activities
Luma	Elegant event pages, RSVPs, guest lists, invitations
TicketCandy	Ticket tiers, checkout, promotion and event commerce
Superprof	Searchable instructor profiles and private lesson discovery
Thumbtack	Professional matching, requests, quotes and bookings
Punchpass	Class passes, attendance, memberships and student management

Differentiation: Nodo connects consumer discovery to instructor operations. A dancer can eventually discover an instructor, book and pay, attend, purchase a class package, and return - all within one integrated product.

3. Problems Nodo solves

Fragmented discovery

Events and instructors are scattered across social channels, private groups, flyers, websites and referrals. Newcomers and travelers struggle to find trustworthy, current information.

Fragmented transactions

After finding an event, dancers may be redirected to unrelated systems to register, purchase admission, or pay for lessons.

Fragmented operations

Instructors frequently manage teaching, marketing, scheduling, student communications, attendance and payments across multiple disconnected tools.

Fragmented community data

There is no universally adopted, structured index of partner dance activity. Nodo aims to organize accurate, permissioned event and professional information.

4. Customer ecosystem

Audience	Need	Proposed value
Social dancers	Find events	Calendar, list, map, filters
Beginners	Find instruction	Searchable teachers and suitable classes
Instructors	Acquire and retain students	Profiles, bookings, payments, management
Studios	Manage multiple offerings	Scheduling, passes, CRM, memberships
Organizers	Sell admission	Event pages, tickets, promotions
Festivals	Coordinate complex programs	Passes, schedules, check-in
DJs and performers	Find opportunities	Professional listings and requests
Venues	Connect with organizers	Venue profiles and relationships

Launch priority should focus on dancers, instructors and organizers; these groups form the initial discovery and supply loop.

5. Product pillars

A. Nodo Discover

The public discovery experience: synchronized Calendar, List and Map views; dance-style filters; search by date, venue, neighborhood and title; recurring and one-time events; instructor and venue profiles; moderation; shareable event pages. Future additions may include follows, saves and reminders.

Primary metric: weekly active discoverers who take a meaningful action after viewing an event or instructor.

B. Nodo Tickets

An integrated event commerce system supporting free RSVP, paid tickets, tiered pricing, early-bird offers, festival passes, discount codes, QR check-in, guest lists, refund workflows, sales dashboards and payout reporting. Registration must connect to the same event records used in discovery.

C. Nodo Instructors

A professional marketplace with profiles, specialties, experience, locations, private/group lesson offerings, videos, languages, pricing, availability and verified reviews after completed services. Proposed journey: search, compare, request or book, pay, attend, review and rebook.

Potential service expansion: wedding choreography, performances, corporate workshops and instructor residencies.

D. Nodo Business OS

A dance-specific operating system for independent instructors and studios: recurring schedules, private appointments, student CRM, prepaid passes and credits, memberships, attendance, cancellation and rescheduling, communications, invoicing, payment reporting and retention analytics.

Module	Responsibility
Students	Permissioned student contact and relationship records
Classes	Recurring group schedules and sessions
Private lessons	One-to-one appointments and availability
Passes	Prepaid credits and redemption
Memberships	Recurring plans and billing
Attendance	Check-in and participation history
Payments	Orders, invoices, refunds and reconciliation
Communications	Reminders and announcements
Analytics	Revenue, utilization and retention

Core proposition: Nodo Discover brings people to instructors; Nodo Business OS helps instructors serve and retain them. Student data must remain private and appropriately permissioned.

E. Nodo Community

Future community capabilities may include dancer profiles, instructor follows, saved venues, city networks and personalized discovery. The objective is real-world participation, not a generic social feed. Participation and tracking should be consent-based.

6. Marketplace flywheel

More instructors and organizers publish accurate offerings; richer supply attracts dancers; engaged dancers generate booking and ticket demand; successful transactions incentivize professionals to use Nodo tools; better tools increase repeat publishing and retention.

This is a strategic hypothesis, not an established moat. It must be validated through repeat usage, retention and transaction data.

7. Business model

Revenue stream	Mechanism	Timing
Ticketing	Per-ticket transaction fee	Early marketplace
Private lessons	Booking commission	Marketplace
Instructor Pro	Monthly subscription	Business OS
Studio plans	Tiered subscription	Business OS
Featured events	Clearly labeled paid placement	After traffic
Festival software	Ticketing and organizer fees	Expansion
Website services	Setup or recurring service fee	Adjacent offering
Analytics	Premium organizer reporting	Mature platform

Illustrative pricing hypotheses only: free public profiles and event submissions; Instructor Pro $19-$39/month; Studio $79-$149/month; ticketing percentage and/or fixed fee. These are unvalidated and must account for payment processing, support and operational costs.

8. Charlotte go-to-market

- Build comprehensive, accurate coverage of active Charlotte events, venues, instructors and recurring classes.
- Onboard a concentrated group of instructors with useful profiles.
- Create repeat discovery habits through weekly event roundups and shareable listings.
- Pilot ticketing with a small number of established organizers.
- Interview instructors about attendance, class passes, private lessons and payments before building the full Business OS.
- Expand city by city only after repeat engagement and reliable supply density are demonstrated.

An empty calendar undermines trust; outdated event information can be worse. Accuracy and freshness are fundamental to the product.

9. Roadmap

Phase	Objective	Deliverables
1 Discovery	Reliable city directory	Events, map, calendar, instructors, moderation
2 Transactions	Convert discovery to purchases	RSVP, tickets, checkout, dashboards
3 Marketplace	Private instruction	Availability, requests, bookings, payments
4 Business OS	Operate teaching businesses	CRM, passes, memberships, attendance
5 Community	Retention and connection	Follows, saves, recommendations
6 Intelligence	Better decisions	Reporting, city insights, analytics

These phases are proposed, not committed dates. Current functionality must be verified in the live application and code repository.

10. Technical architecture and safeguards

Previously discussed technologies include Next.js, TypeScript, Tailwind, Prisma, Neon PostgreSQL, Cloudinary, and Google/passwordless authentication. The agent must audit the current repository before presenting these as verified dependencies.

Domain	Example entities
Identity	Users, roles, organizations
Discovery	Events, occurrences, venues, dance styles
Professionals	Profiles, services, qualifications
Commerce	Orders, tickets, payments, refunds
Bookings	Availability, appointments, cancellations
Learning	Classes, enrollments, attendance
Memberships	Passes, credits, subscriptions
CRM	Student relationships, notes, communications
Trust	Reviews, moderation, verification
Analytics	Aggregated activity and conversion metrics

Important data modeling distinction

A recurring class offering, a dated class session, a student booking, a prepaid pass, and an attendance record are related but distinct entities. Avoid overloading one generic Event model with every future workflow.

Engineering rules

- Keep Calendar, List and Map synchronized through shared event queries and filters.
- Use consistent timezone handling and test daylight saving boundaries.
- Default to one-off events; recur only when explicitly selected.
- Support recurrence exceptions and editing individual occurrences.
- Preserve original venue addresses while using resilient geocoding fallback.
- Use a single dance-style color token source.
- Enforce tenant and role authorization for organizations, instructors and students.
- Use compliant payment providers; never store raw payment card information.
- Make webhooks idempotent and maintain audit logs.
- Test event submission, moderation, booking, cancellation and payment flows.

11. Brand and messaging

Positioning: a sophisticated, modern, culturally aware technology platform built for real-world dance. Not a generic nightlife app or chaotic event flyer board.

Palette (approximate): deep navy #19213F; warm off-white #F5F5F3; coral-orange-pink accent gradient. Confirm exact tokens from original logo and source files.

Semantic dance colors: Salsa #E85D5D; Bachata #F4A261; Kizomba #6C63FF; Tango #2F3E46; Zouk #00B4D8; Other #9CA3AF. Apply consistently across maps, calendars, lists and filters.

Audience	Message
Dancers	Discover where to dance.
Instructors	Get discovered. Grow your teaching business.
Organizers	Bring your events and audience together.
Studios	Run your dance business in one place.
Company	Connecting the Dance Community.

Support the breadth of partner dance culture, including Salsa, Bachata, Tango, Kizomba, Zouk, Swing, Ballroom, Carolina Shag and other traditions. Use clear, warm, confident language without exaggerated claims.

12. Success metrics

Stage	Suggested metrics
Discovery	Weekly active users, repeat visitors, event coverage
Supply	Active organizers, instructor profiles, listing freshness
Engagement	Event views, saves, outbound actions
Ticketing	Gross ticket sales, purchase conversion, refund rate
Marketplace	Requests, completed lessons, repeat bookings
Business OS	Paying professionals, retention, recurring revenue
Expansion	City-level supply density, organic acquisition

A critical metric is weekly discovery-to-action conversion: the share of event discoverers who take a meaningful action. Page views alone do not prove marketplace value.

13. Obsidian vault structure

Nodo-Dance/

- 00 - Company HQ/
  - Company Overview.md
  - Mission and Vision.md
  - Founder Thesis.md
  - Strategic Decisions.md
- 01 - Brand/
  - Brand Bible.md
  - Visual Identity.md
  - Voice and Messaging.md
  - Audience Personas.md
- 02 - Product/
  - Product Vision.md
  - Nodo Discover.md
  - Nodo Tickets.md
  - Nodo Instructors.md
  - Nodo Business OS.md
  - Nodo Community.md

- User Journeys.md
- 03 - Engineering/
  - Current Architecture.md
  - Data Models.md
  - API Contracts.md
  - Authentication.md
  - Payments.md
  - Event Recurrence.md
  - Known Bugs.md
- 04 - Business/
  - Business Model.md
  - Pricing Hypotheses.md
  - Marketplace Flywheel.md
  - Competitive Landscape.md
  - Unit Economics.md
- 05 - Growth/
  - Charlotte Launch.md
  - Instructor Acquisition.md
  - Organizer Acquisition.md
  - Marketing Campaigns.md
  - City Expansion.md
- 06 - Research/
  - Competitor Notes.md
  - Customer Interviews.md
  - Market Research.md
- 07 - Roadmap/
  - Now.md
  - Next.md
  - Later.md
  - Backlog.md
- 08 - Operations/
  - Weekly Reviews.md
  - KPIs.md
  - Decision Log.md
- 99 - Sources/

Website Audit.md

Repository Audit.md

External References.md

Metadata example

title: Nodo Tickets | type: product-module | status: planned | evidence: founder-vision | owner: founder | last_reviewed: 2026-11-04 | related: [[Product Vision]], [[Business Model]], [[Nodo Discover]]

Maintain separate classifications for verified facts, strategic decisions, hypotheses, roadmap items and external research. Each note should have source references, last-reviewed dates and wikilinks to related notes.

14. Master AI knowledge agent directive

Role: You are Nodo Dance's company knowledge architect and strategic research agent. Build and maintain an accurate, structured, interconnected Obsidian vault covering mission, product, engineering, brand, business, growth and roadmap.

Required operating rules

- Create individual Markdown notes for meaningful concepts, with Obsidian [[wikilinks]] and a central navigation hub.
- Separate current implementation, founder-approved strategy, future roadmap and unvalidated hypotheses.
- Never invent revenue, user numbers, traction, partnerships, capabilities or market size.
- Audit the actual website and repository before documenting technical facts or declaring features complete.
- Record important decisions and preserve historical context; flag conflicts instead of silently rewriting facts.
- Maintain a Known Bugs note linked to affected product modules.
- Study competitors by capabilities, audience, pricing, strengths and limitations, citing sources.
- Keep business strategy, market research and technical architecture in distinct but linked notes.
- Document evidence and review dates, and identify assumptions that require founder confirmation.
- Make the vault navigable by future AI agents, developers, marketers, investors and employees.

Central strategic thesis

Discovery attracts dancers. The marketplace connects them to professionals. Transactions create economic activity. Business tools help instructors retain students. Community relationships encourage repeat participation. This integrated loop is the hypothesis Nodo must test.

15. Long-term thesis and final principle

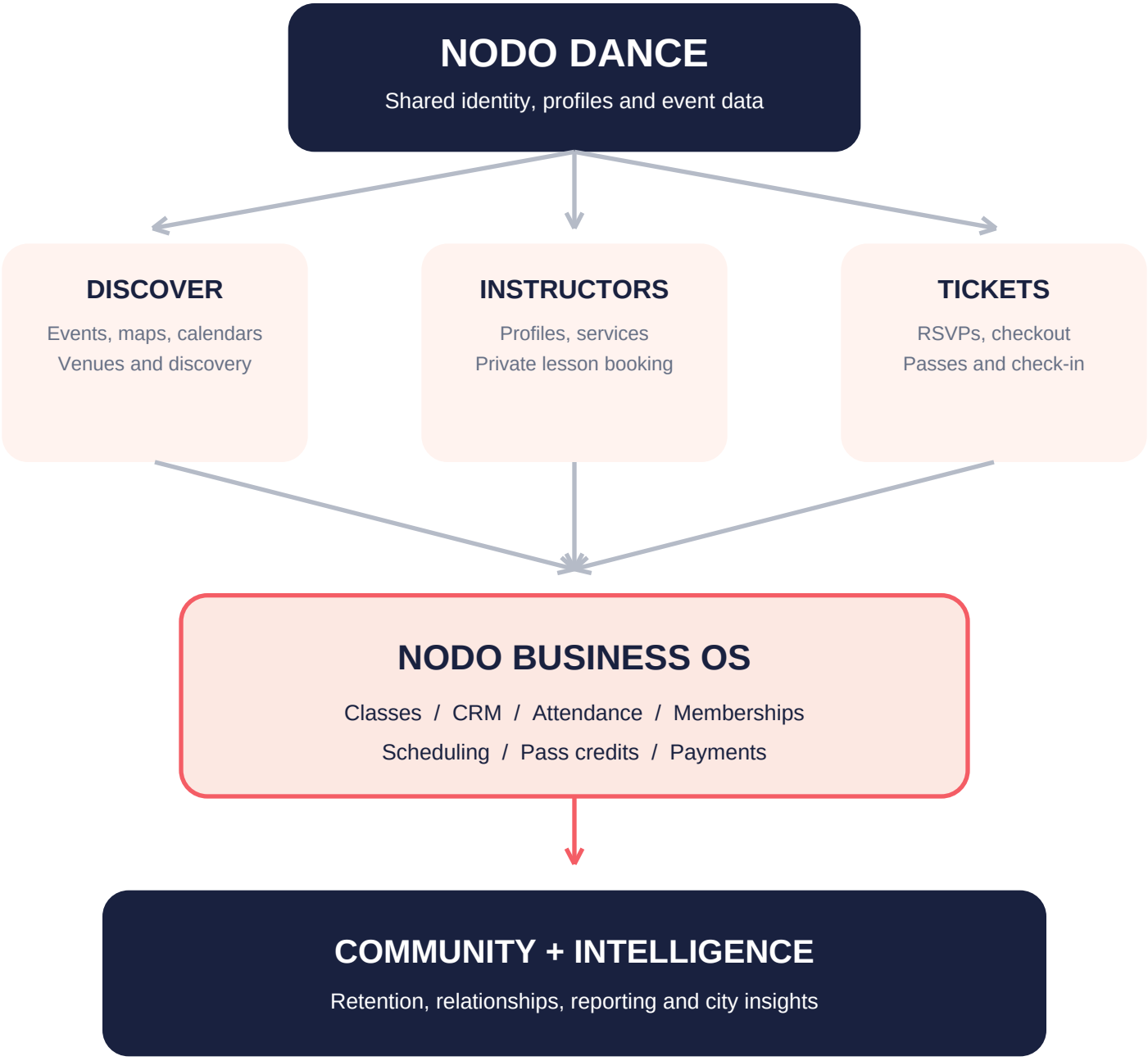
Nodo is not simply a better Eventbrite for dancers. It aims to connect discovery, registration, payments, teaching and business operations. The most defensible opportunity would be to serve as both a demand-generation channel and an operational system for dance professionals.

The immediate priority remains narrower: become indispensable for finding reliable events and instructors in Charlotte. Once repeat discovery habits exist, ticketing and bookings become natural extensions. Business software should solve validated instructor needs, not merely add features.

Nodo Dance should make it easier for people to dance, and easier for dance professionals to make a living doing what they love.

Nodo Product Architecture

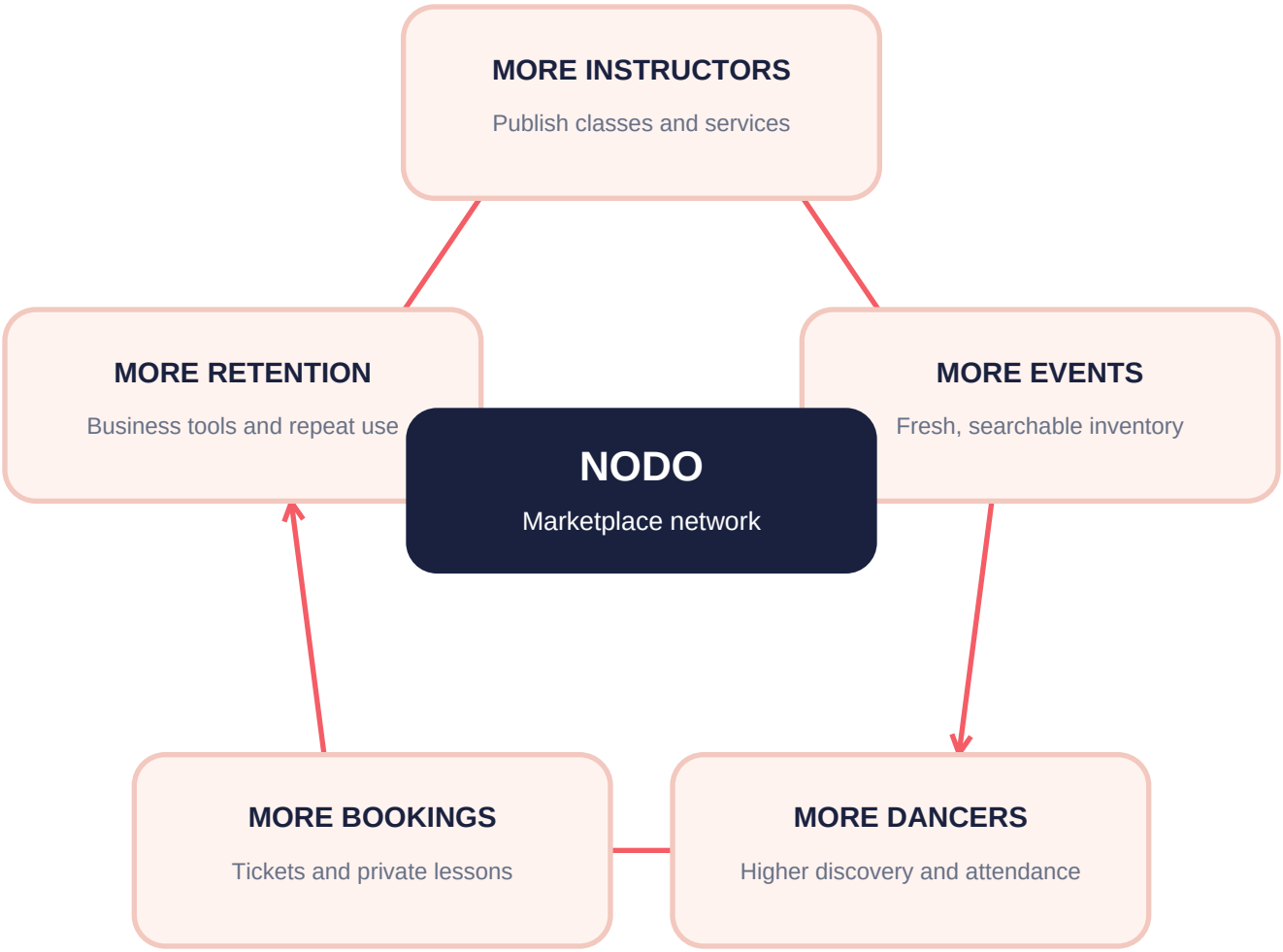
Five connected product pillars, built on shared platform infrastructure



Conceptual target architecture - not a list of live features.

The Nodo Network Flywheel

The growth hypothesis linking supply, demand, transactions and retention

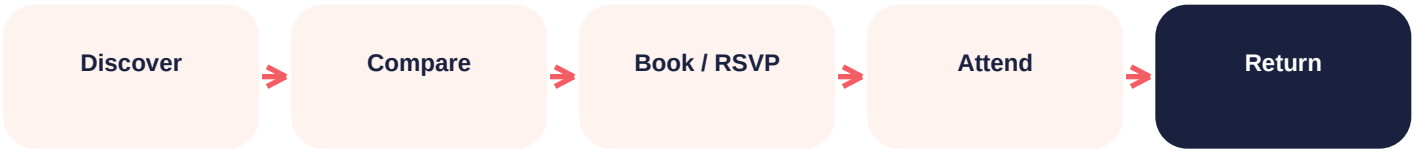


Validation needed: active supply, repeat discovery, completed bookings, and instructor retention. A flywheel is a hypothesis until measured.

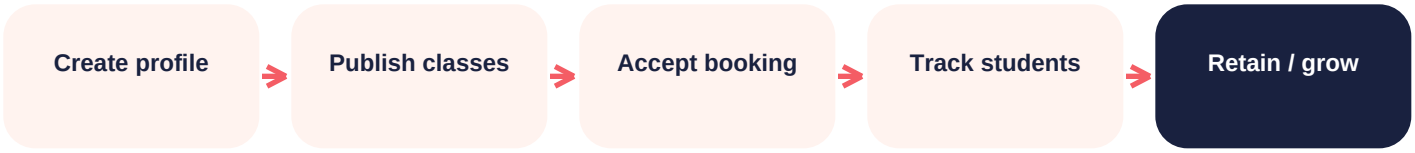
Connected User Journeys

One continuous experience for dancers, instructors and organizers

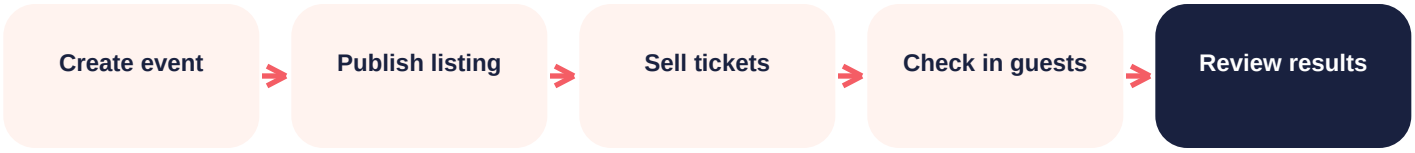
DANCER



INSTRUCTOR



ORGANIZER



Core thesis

Discovery brings people in. Transactions create economic activity.

Business tools help professionals serve and retain their customers.

Community participation encourages repeat engagement.